

REST API Design

Backend development study note for document retrieval and grounded question-answering practice.

Resources and paths

Resource-oriented APIs identify entities using paths such as `/users/17` or `/orders/800`. Paths should be consistent and describe resources; HTTP methods describe the operation.

API contract

An API contract documents paths, methods, request and response formats, status codes, authentication requirements, and relevant constraints. Clear contracts help clients integrate reliably.

Pagination and filtering

Collections can become large. APIs commonly support pagination and filtering so clients can request manageable subsets of data. The exact query parameters and ordering behavior should be documented.